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Pakistan sealed a 3-0 sweep against Sri Lanka with a composed chase of 212 in the third ODI, built on Fakhar Zaman's brisk start and a calm partnership between Mohammad Rizwan and Hussain Talat. Earlier in the series, Babar Azam's first international hundred in over two years underpinned a comfortable pursuit of 289 in the second ODI, after Sri Lanka's wayward new-ball spell let the game slip. The opener had been the tightest contest, Pakistan edging a six-run win despite Wanindu Hasaranga's spirited all-round effort.



3

Kumar Sangakkara has returned as Rajasthan Royals' head coach for IPL 2026 while continuing as Director of Cricket, the franchise has confirmed. He previously held the coaching role from 2021 to 2024, a period in which the Royals reached the 2022 final and made the IPL 2024 playoffs, before Rahul Dravid stepped in for the 2025 season. Meanwhile, Vikram Rathore has been elevated to the position of lead assistant coach while Shane Bond will continue as the bowling coach.



4

The 2026 IPL auction will be held on December 16 in Abu Dhabi, marking the league's third straight overseas auction. The IPL first moved the event abroad in 2024 with the Dubai auction, followed by the two-day mega auction in Jeddah for the 2025 season. Like all mini auctions, the 2026 edition, too, will be a day-long exercise.



5

Afghanistan will host West Indies for a three-match T20I series in the UAE from January 19 to 22 next year, the Afghanistan Cricket Board has confirmed. The games are scheduled for January 19, 21 and 22. With the 2026 Men's T20 World Cup to be held in India and Sri Lanka, the series offers timely match practice and a chance to fine-tune combinations ahead of a busy buildup.